

Draft - expert review pending

This unit is complete and passes the platform's automated checks, but no reviewer has read it yet. Treat its sources and claims with care.

Unit 1 teacher notes

Sequencing note

The four topics form one arc. Topic 1.1 gives the map (the field, the spheres). Topic 1.2 gives the engine (the nexus and the scales). Topic 1.3 applies both to living systems and resources. Topic 1.4 hands the whole thing to the learner. Teach them in order across the two weeks the guide allows, and keep the worked examples alive across topics: the Karachi air from 1.1 returns as a scale example in 1.2, and the Keenjhar Lake from 1.3 returns as a resource rate in 1.3 and a practicum option in 1.4.

Teaching strategies (from the course guide)

The guide names interactive lectures, seminars, group work, case studies, presentations, guided reading, home study and individual tutorials. This unit leans on three of them: interactive lecture for the four spheres and the nexus (pause every few minutes and ask for a local example), group work for the headline sort and the resource debate, and case study for the waterlogging chain and the mangrove services. The home-study element is the one-week log in Topic 1.4, which needs to be set up in week one, not discovered in week two.

Common misconceptions to probe

1. **"The environment means nature far away."** Probe with the school itself: ask what the air over the courtyard, the water tank and the soil in the garden have in common with a forest. The answer you want is that both are surroundings affecting living things, which is the definition.

2. **"Global problems are the real ones; local ones are too small."** Probe with the multiplication question from Topic 1.4: one wrapper times one class times one city. The scales are one system.
3. **"Resources are infinite because nature renews them."** Probe with the tube-well example: if renewal is a rate, what happens when pumping is a faster rate? The word to land on is "rate", not "shortage".
4. **"Conservation is the government's job."** Do not dismiss this; half of it is true. The honest answer, which the unit teaches, is that policy matters more and individual action still counts, especially a teacher's.

Managing the activities

Topic 1.1, Sort the questions (20 minutes, pairs). The trap is sorting by topic word ("smog" to air) without asking which spheres are involved. Push for the second question. Keep eight headlines ready on cards; Dawn and The News environment pages give a week's worth.

Topic 1.2, Headline scale sort (25 minutes, groups of three). Arguments are the point. The judgement call between regional and global (Indus water stress, for example) is where the learning happens. Ask the arguing group to state the rule they used, not just the answer.

Topic 1.3, Resource rate debate (25 minutes, two groups). Assign roles firmly; pupils argue better as fishers or managers than as themselves. The debrief question is the one to protect time for: what rule could both sides accept, and why?

Topic 1.4, The one-week audit (set up in 15 minutes, two weeks at home). The setup session must produce a real, shared log format, two lines a day. Pairs compare weeks in the follow-up session; the before-and-after counts are the presentation.

Practical work and practicum links

Each topic carries a practicum task, and Topic 1.4's two-bin classroom trial is the unit's main practical: it needs the cooperating teacher's agreement, two weeks, and nothing else. The guide allocates a practical hour each week under the (2-1) credit split; the audit and the trial are its natural carriers in this unit. Debrief all four tasks in the last session of the unit, because Unit 2 (water and waste) picks up exactly where the log and the trial leave off.

Tip: select any text on this page first to comment on that specific passage - or leave nothing selected for general feedback.

[Give feedback](#)